

Don't Just Work Hard, Work Smart: Introduction, Featuring Marie Mouchet

Marie Mouchet, VP & CIO, Colonial Pipeline Company

Pat Summitt was as hard a worker as anyone, but her legendary success and legacy as a coach are as much a result of working smart as they are of working hard. We've all heard the famous definition of insanity: doing the same thing over and over again, but expecting different results. When you work hard, but lack strategy, you may well find yourself exemplifying that definition.

Coach Summitt always grew from her challenges. She surrounded herself with assistant coaches (and) she deeply respected and listened to them when they provided feedback on her decisions, methods, or strategies. She stayed open to improvement and constantly looked for mentors, teachers, and other coaches from whom she could learn new methods.

When Pat's rival, Geno Auriemma from the University of Connecticut changed women's basketball using the dominant triple-post offense, Coach Summitt became a student of the triple-post in order to learn how to defend against it. Rather than stew in resentment over UConn's success or doggedly pursue the same methods for trying to beat her opponent, Pat made the conscious decision to evolve as a leader.

She visited the Chicago Bulls and learned from the masters of the triple-post offense, Tex Winter and Phil Jackson. The following year, the Lady Vols integrated triple-post concepts into their game play. The shift in strategy proved successful as the team went on to win the championship three years in a row.

Pat Summitt never stopped working hard, but she learned how to maximize the impact of her hard work by continually finding ways to work smarter. As her leadership maturity increased, so did her abilities in strategizing, team building, and finding balance between her strengths and weaknesses.

In this module, you'll hear from visionary strategist Sue Nokes, an experienced senior executive who currently serves as the advisory board vice chairman at the leading tech company Asurion. She previously worked as the chief customer and operations officer for T-Mobile. Sue was a close friend of Pat Summitt's and sat in many locker rooms with Pat's championship teams, so she has first-hand experience with Pat's methods for outworking and outsmarting her opponents.